

Chapter 1

The axisymmetric equations of linear elasticity

The aim of this tutorial is to demonstrate the solution of the axisymmetric equations of linear elasticity in cylindrical polar coordinates.

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1.1 Theory

Consider a three-dimensional, axisymmetric body (of density ρ , Young's modulus E , and Poisson's ratio ν), occupying the region D whose boundary is ∂D . Using cylindrical coordinates (r^*, θ, z^*) , the equations of linear elasticity can be written as

$$\nabla^* \cdot \boldsymbol{\tau}^* + \rho \mathbf{F}^* = \rho \frac{\partial^2 \mathbf{u}^*}{\partial t^{*2}},$$

where $\nabla^* = (\frac{\partial}{\partial r^*}, \frac{1}{r^*} \frac{\partial}{\partial \theta}, \frac{\partial}{\partial z^*})$, $\boldsymbol{\tau}^*(r^*, z^*, t^*)$ is the stress tensor, $\mathbf{F}^*(r^*, z^*, t^*)$ is the body force and $\mathbf{u}^*(r^*, z^*, t^*)$ is the displacement field.

Note that, despite the fact that none of the above physical quantities depend on the azimuthal angle θ , each can have a non-zero θ component. Also note that variables written with a superscript asterisk are dimensional, and their non-dimensional counterparts will be written without an asterisk. (The coordinate θ is, by definition, non-dimensional, so it will always be written without an asterisk.)

A boundary traction $\hat{\boldsymbol{\tau}}^*$ and boundary displacement $\hat{\mathbf{u}}^*$ are imposed along the boundaries ∂D_n and ∂D_d respectively, where $\partial D = \partial D_d \cup \partial D_n$ so that

$$\mathbf{u}^* = \hat{\mathbf{u}}^* \text{ on } \partial D_d, \quad \boldsymbol{\tau}^* \cdot \mathbf{n} = \hat{\boldsymbol{\tau}}^* \text{ on } \partial D_n,$$

where $\mathbf{n}$ is the outer unit normal vector.

The constitutive equations relating the stresses to the displacements are

$$\boldsymbol{\tau}^* = \frac{E}{1 + \nu} \left(\frac{\nu}{1 - 2\nu} (\nabla^* \cdot \mathbf{u}^*) \mathbf{I} + \frac{1}{2} (\nabla^* \mathbf{u}^* + (\nabla^* \mathbf{u}^*)^T) \right),$$

where $\mathbf{I}$ is the identity tensor and superscript T denotes the transpose. In cylindrical coordinates, the matrix

representation of the tensor $\nabla^* \mathbf{u}^*$ is

$$\nabla^* \mathbf{u}^* = \begin{pmatrix} \frac{\partial u_r^*}{\partial r^*} & -\frac{u_\theta^*}{r^*} & \frac{\partial u_r^*}{\partial z^*} \\ \frac{\partial u_\theta^*}{\partial r^*} & \frac{u_r^*}{r^*} & \frac{\partial u_\theta^*}{\partial z^*} \\ \frac{\partial u_z^*}{\partial r^*} & 0 & \frac{\partial u_z^*}{\partial z^*} \end{pmatrix}$$

and $\nabla^* \cdot \mathbf{u}^*$ is equal to the trace of this matrix.

We non-dimensionalise the equations, using a problem specific reference length, $\mathcal{L}$, and a timescale $\mathcal{T}$, and use Young's modulus to non-dimensionalise the body force and the stress tensor:

$$\begin{aligned} \boldsymbol{\tau}^* &= E \boldsymbol{\tau}, & r^* &= \mathcal{L} r, & z^* &= \mathcal{L} z \\ \mathbf{u}^* &= \mathcal{L} \mathbf{u} & \mathbf{F}^* &= \frac{E}{\rho \mathcal{L}} \mathbf{F}, & t^* &= \mathcal{T} t. \end{aligned}$$

The non-dimensional form of the axisymmetric linear elasticity equations is then given by

$$\nabla \cdot \boldsymbol{\tau} + \mathbf{F} = \Lambda^2 \frac{\partial^2 \mathbf{u}}{\partial t^2}, \quad (1)$$

where $\nabla = \left(\frac{\partial}{\partial r}, \frac{1}{r} \frac{\partial}{\partial \theta}, \frac{\partial}{\partial z} \right)$,

$$\boldsymbol{\tau} = \frac{1}{1+\nu} \left(\frac{\nu}{1-2\nu} (\nabla \cdot \mathbf{u}) \mathbf{I} + \frac{1}{2} (\nabla \mathbf{u} + (\nabla \mathbf{u})^T) \right), \quad (2)$$

and the non-dimensional parameter

$$\Lambda = \frac{\mathcal{L}}{\mathcal{T}} \sqrt{\frac{\rho}{E}}$$

is the ratio of the elastic body's intrinsic timescale, $\mathcal{L} \sqrt{\frac{\rho}{E}}$, to the problem-specific timescale, $\mathcal{T}$, that we use for time-dependent problems. The boundary conditions are

$$\mathbf{u} = \hat{\mathbf{u}} \text{ on } \partial D_d \quad \boldsymbol{\tau} \cdot \mathbf{n} = \hat{\boldsymbol{\tau}} \text{ on } \partial D_n.$$

We must also specify initial conditions:

$$\mathbf{u}|_{t=t_0} = \mathbf{u}^0, \quad \left. \frac{\partial \mathbf{u}}{\partial t} \right|_{t=t_0} = \mathbf{v}^0. \quad (3)$$

1.2 Implementation

Within `omph-lib`, the non-dimensional version of the axisymmetric linear elasticity equations (1) combined with the constitutive equations (2) are implemented in the `AxisymmetricLinearElasticityEquations` class. This class implements the equations in a way which is general with respect to the specific element geometry. To obtain a fully functioning element class, we must combine the equations class with a specific geometric element class, as discussed in the [\(Not-So-\)Quick Guide](#). For example, we will combine the `AxisymmetricLinearElasticityEquations` class with `QElement<2, 3>` elements, which are 9-node quadrilateral elements, in our example problem. As usual, the mapping between local and global (Eulerian) coordinates within an element is given by

$$x_i = \sum_{j=1}^{N^{(E)}} X_{ij}^{(E)} \psi_j, \quad i = 1, 2,$$

where $x_1 = r, x_2 = z$; $N^{(E)}$ is the number of nodes in the element. $X_{ij}^{(E)}$ is the i -th global (Eulerian) coordinate of the j -th node in the element and the ψ_j are the element's shape functions, which are specific to each type of geometric element.

We store the three components of the displacement vector as nodal data in the order u_r, u_z, u_θ and use the shape functions to interpolate the displacements as

$$u_i = \sum_{j=1}^{N(E)} U_{ij}^{(E)} \psi_{ij}, \quad i = 1, \dots, 3,$$

where U_{ij} is the i -th displacement component at the j -th node in the element, i.e., $u_1 = u_r, u_2 = u_z, u_3 = u_\theta$. The solution of time dependent problems requires the specification of a `TimeStepper` that is capable of approximating second time derivatives. In the example problem below we use the Newmark timestepper.

1.3 The test problem

As a test problem we consider forced oscillations of the circular cylinder shown in the sketch below:

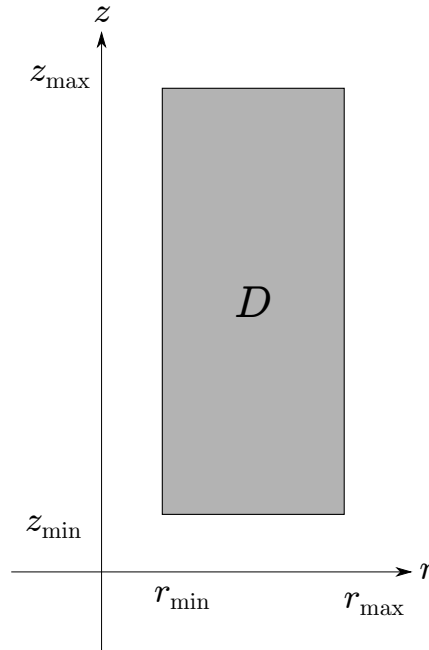


Figure 1.1 Azimuthal cross-section of the geometry.

It is difficult to find non-trivial exact solutions of the governing equations (1), (2), so we manufacture a time-harmonic solution:

$$\mathbf{u} = \begin{pmatrix} u_r \\ u_\theta \\ u_z \end{pmatrix} = \cos(t) \begin{pmatrix} r^3 \cos(z) \\ r^3 z^3 \\ r^3 \sin(z) \end{pmatrix}. \quad (4)$$

This is an exact solution if we set the body force to

$$\mathbf{F} = \cos(t) \begin{pmatrix} -r \cos(z) \{ (8 + 3r) \lambda + (16 - r(r - 3)) \mu + r^2 \Lambda^2 \} \\ -r \{ 8z^3 \mu + r^2 (z^3 \Lambda^2 + 6\mu z) \} \\ r \sin(z) \{ -9\mu + 4r(\lambda + \mu) + r^2 (\lambda + 2\mu - \Lambda^2) \} \end{pmatrix}, \quad (5)$$

where $\lambda = \nu / ((1 + \nu)(1 - 2\nu))$ and $\mu = 1 / (2(1 + \nu))$ are the nondimensional Lamé parameters. We impose the displacement along the boundaries $r = r_{\max}, z = z_{\min}, z = z_{\max}$ according to (4), and impose the traction

$$\hat{\tau}_3 = \boldsymbol{\tau}(r_{\min}, z, t) = \cos(\omega t) \begin{pmatrix} -\cos(z) r_{\min}^2 (6\mu + \lambda(4 + r_{\min})) \\ -2\mu r_{\min}^2 z^3 \\ -\mu r_{\min}^2 \sin(z) (3 - r_{\min}) \end{pmatrix}, \quad (6)$$

along the boundary $r = r_{\min}$.

The problem we are solving then consists of equations (1), (2) along with the body force, (5) and boundary traction (6). The initial conditions for the problem are the exact displacement, velocity (and acceleration; see below) according to the solution (4).

1.4 Results

The animation below shows the time dependent deformation of the cylinder in the r - z plane, while the colour contours indicate the azimuthal displacement component. The animation is for $t \in [0, 2\pi]$, since the time scale is nondimensionalised on the reciprocal of the angular frequency of the oscillations.



Figure 1.2 Animation (HTML only) of the resulting displacement field.

The next three figures show plots of the radial, axial and azimuthal displacements as functions of (r, z) at $t = 2.64$. Note the excellent agreement between the numerical and exact solutions.

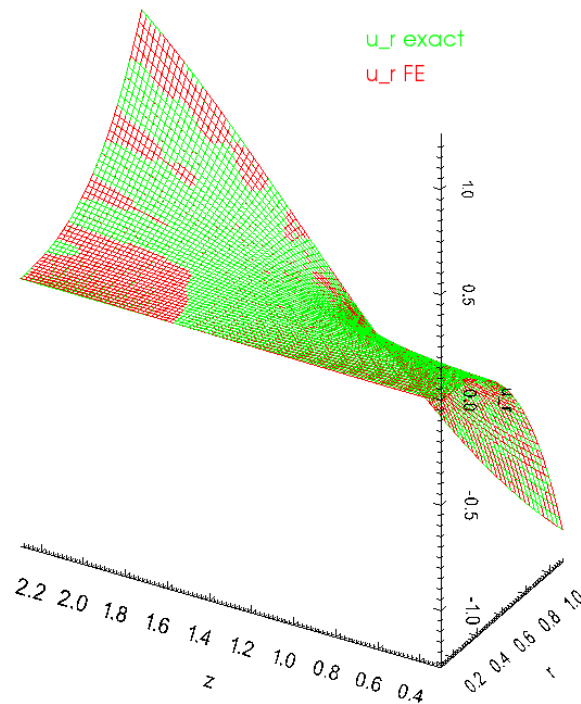


Figure 1.3 Comparison between exact and FE solutions for the r-component of displacement at $t = 2.64$

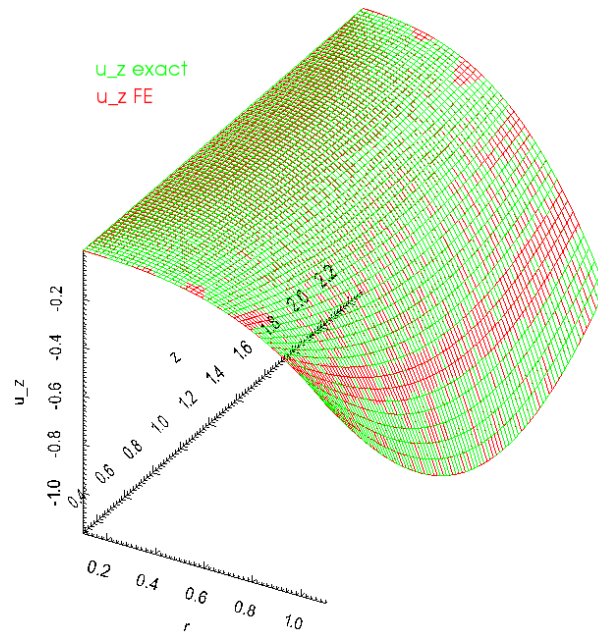


Figure 1.4 Comparison between exact and FE solutions for the z-component of displacement at $t = 2.64$

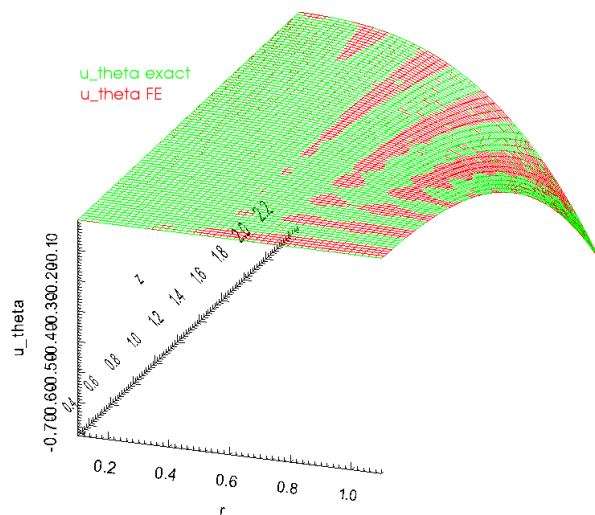


Figure 1.5 Comparison between exact and FE solutions for the theta-component of displacement at $t = 2.64$

1.5 Global parameters and functions

As usual, we define all non-dimensional parameters in a namespace. In this namespace, we also define the body force, the traction to be applied on the boundary $r = r_{\min}$, and the exact solution. Note that, consistent with the enumeration of the unknowns, discussed above, the order of the components in the functions that specify the body force and the surface traction is (r, z, θ) .

```

//===start_of_Global_Parameters_namespace=====
// Namespace for global parameters
//=====
namespace Global_Parameters
{
    /// Define Poisson's ratio Nu
    double Nu = 0.3;

    /// Define the non-dimensional Young's modulus
    double E = 1.0;

    /// Lamé parameters
    double Lambda = E*Nu/(1.0+Nu)/(1.0-2.0*Nu);

```

```

double Mu = E/2.0/(1.0+Nu);

/// Square of the frequency of the time dependence
double Omega_sq = 0.5;

/// Number of elements in r-direction
unsigned Nr = 5;

/// Number of elements in z-direction
unsigned Nz = 10;

/// Length of domain in r direction
double Lr = 1.0;

/// Length of domain in z-direction
double Lz = 2.0;

/// Set up min r coordinate
double Rmin = 0.1;

/// Set up min z coordinate
double Zmin = 0.3;

/// Set up max r coordinate
double Rmax = Rmin+Lr;

/// Set up max z coordinate
double Zmax = Zmin+Lz;

/// The traction function at r=Rmin: (t_r, t_z, t_theta)
void boundary_traction(const double &time,
                      const Vector<double> &x,
                      const Vector<double> &n,
                      Vector<double> &result)
{
    result[0] = cos(time)*(-6.0*pow(x[0],2)*Mu*cos(x[1])-
        Lambda*(4.0*pow(x[0],2)+pow(x[0],3))*cos(x[1]));
    result[1] = cos(time)*(-Mu*(3.0*pow(x[0],2)-pow(x[0],3))*sin(x[1]));
    result[2] = cos(time)*(-Mu*pow(x[0],2)*(2*pow(x[1],3)));
}

/// The body force function; returns vector of doubles
/// in the order (b_r, b_z, b_theta)
void body_force(const double &time,
               const Vector<double> &x,
               Vector<double> &result)
{
    result[0] = cos(time)*
        x[0]*(-cos(x[1])*
            (Lambda*(8.0+3.0*x[0])-
            Mu*(-16.0+x[0]*(x[0]-3.0))+pow(x[0],2)*Omega_sq));
    result[1] = cos(time)*
        x[0]*sin(x[1])*
        (Mu*(-9.0)+
        4.0*x[0]*(Lambda+Mu)+pow(x[0],2)*
        (Lambda+2.0*Mu-Omega_sq));
    result[2] = cos(time)*
        -x[0]*(8.0*Mu*pow(x[1],3)+pow(x[0],2)*(pow(x[1],3)*Omega_sq+6.0*Mu*x[1]));
} // end of body force

```

In addition, the namespace includes the necessary machinery for providing the time dependent equations with their initial data from the exact solution. There are 9 functions, one for each of the components of displacement, velocity and acceleration, and a helper function. For brevity, we list only one of these functions; the others are similar.

```

/// Calculate the time dependent form of the r-component of displacement
double u_r(const double &time, const Vector<double> &x)
{
    Vector<double> displ(3);
    exact_solution_th(x, displ);
    return cos(time)*displ[0];
} // end of u_r

```

1.6 The driver code

We start by creating a DocInfo object that will be used to output the solution, and then build the problem.

```

//===start_of_main=====
/// Driver code
//========
int main(int argc, char* argv[])
{
    // Store command line arguments
    CommandLineArgs::setup(argc, argv);

    // Define possible command line arguments and parse the ones that

```

```
// were actually specified

// Validation?
CommandLineArgs::specify_command_line_flag("--validation");

// Parse command line
CommandLineArgs::parse_and_assign();

// Doc what has actually been specified on the command line
CommandLineArgs::doc_specified_flags();

// Set up doc info
DocInfo doc_info;

// Set output directory
doc_info.set_directory("RESLT");

// Time dependent problem instance
AxisymmetricLinearElasticityProblem
<QAxisymmetricLinearElasticityElement<3>, Newmark<1> > problem;
```

Next we set up a timestepper and assign the initial conditions.

```
// Set the initial time to t=0
problem.time_pt()->time()=0.0;

// Set and initialise timestep
double dt=0;

// If we're validating, use a larger timestep so that we can do fewer steps
// before reaching interesting behaviour
if(CommandLineArgs::command_line_flag_has_been_set("--validation"))
{
    dt=0.1;
}
else // Otherwise use a small timestep
{
    dt=0.01;
}
problem.time_pt()->initialise_dt(dt);

// Set the initial conditions
problem.set_initial_conditions();

// Doc the initial conditions and increment the doc_info number
problem.doc_solution(doc_info);
doc_info.number()++;
```

We calculate the number of timesteps to perform - if we are validating, just do small number of timesteps; otherwise do a full period the time-harmonic oscillation.

```
// Find the number of timesteps to perform
unsigned nstep=0;

// If we're validating, only do a few timesteps; otherwise do a whole period
if(CommandLineArgs::command_line_flag_has_been_set("--validation"))
{
    nstep=5;
}
else // Otherwise calculate based on timestep
{
    // Solve for one full period
    double t_max=2*MathematicalConstants::Pi;

    nstep=unsigned(t_max/dt);
} //end_of_calculate_number_of_timesteps
```

Finally we perform a time dependent simulation.

```
// Do the timestepping
for(unsigned istep=0; istep<nstep; istep++)
{
    // Solve for this timestep
    problem.unsteady_newton_solve(dt);

    // Doc the solution and increment doc_info number
    problem.doc_solution(doc_info);
    doc_info.number()++;
}
} // end_of_main
```

1.7 The problem class

The problem class is very simple, and similarly to other problems with Neumann conditions, there are separate meshes for the "bulk" elements and the "face" elements that apply the traction boundary conditions. The function `assign_traction_elements()` attaches the traction elements to the appropriate bulk elements.

```
//===start_of_problem_class=====
/// Class to validate time harmonic linear elasticity (Fourier
```

```

/// decomposed)
//=====
template<class ELEMENT, class TIMESTEPPER>
class AxisymmetricLinearElasticityProblem : public Problem
{
public:

    /// Constructor: Pass number of elements in r and z directions,
    /// boundary locations and whether we are doing an impulsive start or not
    AxisymmetricLinearElasticityProblem();

    /// Update before solve is empty
    void actions_before_newton_solve() {}

    /// Update after solve is empty
    void actions_after_newton_solve() {}

    /// Actions before implicit timestep
    void actions_before_implicit_timestep()
    {
        // Just need to update the boundary conditions
        set_boundary_conditions();
    }

    /// Set the initial conditions, either for an impulsive start or
    /// with history values for the time stepper
    void set_initial_conditions();

    /// Set the boundary conditions
    void set_boundary_conditions();

    /// Doc the solution
    void doc_solution(DocInfo& doc_info);
private:

    /// Allocate traction elements on the bottom surface
    void assign_traction_elements();

    /// Pointer to the bulk mesh
    Mesh* Bulk_mesh_pt;

    /// Pointer to the mesh of traction elements
    Mesh* Surface_mesh_pt;
}; // end_of_problem_class

```

1.8 The problem constructor

The problem constructor creates the mesh objects (which in turn create the elements), pins the appropriate boundary nodes and assigns the boundary conditions according to the functions defined in the [Global_Parameters](#) namespace.

```

//====start_of_constructor=====
/// Problem constructor: Pass number of elements in coordinate
/// directions and size of domain.
//=====
template<class ELEMENT, class TIMESTEPPER>
AxisymmetricLinearElasticityProblem<ELEMENT, TIMESTEPPER>::
AxisymmetricLinearElasticityProblem()
{
    //Allocate the timestepper
    add_time_stepper_pt(new TIMESTEPPER());

    //Now create the mesh
    Bulk_mesh_pt = new RectangularQuadMesh<ELEMENT>(
        Global_Parameters::Nr,
        Global_Parameters::Nz,
        Global_Parameters::Rmin,
        Global_Parameters::Rmax,
        Global_Parameters::Zmin,
        Global_Parameters::Zmax,
        time_stepper_pt());

    //Create the surface mesh of traction elements
    Surface_mesh_pt=new Mesh;
    assign_traction_elements();
    //Set the boundary conditions
    set_boundary_conditions();
}

```

Then the physical parameters are set for each element in the bulk mesh.

```

// Complete the problem setup to make the elements fully functional

// Loop over the elements
unsigned n_el = Bulk_mesh_pt->nelement();
for(unsigned e=0;e<n_el;e++)

```



```

{
    // Cast to a bulk element
    ELEMENT *el_pt = dynamic_cast<ELEMENT*>(Bulk_mesh_pt->element_pt(e));

    // Set the body force
    el_pt->body_force_fct_pt() = &Global_Parameters::body_force;

    // Set the pointer to Poisson's ratio
    el_pt->nu_pt() = &Global_Parameters::Nu;

    // Set the pointer to non-dim Young's modulus
    el_pt->youngs_modulus_pt() = &Global_Parameters::E;

    // Set the pointer to the Lambda parameter
    el_pt->lambda_sq_pt() = &Global_Parameters::Omega_sq;

} // end_loop_over_elements

```

We then loop over the traction elements and set the applied traction.

```

// Loop over the traction elements
unsigned n_traction = Surface_mesh_pt->nelement();
for(unsigned e=0;e<n_traction;e++)
{
    // Cast to a surface element
    AxisymmetricLinearElasticityTractionElement<ELEMENT*>*
    el_pt =
    dynamic_cast<AxisymmetricLinearElasticityTractionElement
    <ELEMENT*>* >(Surface_mesh_pt->element_pt(e));

    // Set the applied traction
    el_pt->traction_fct_pt() = &Global_Parameters::boundary_traction;

} // end_loop_over_traction_elements

```

Finally, we add the two meshes as sub-meshes, build a global mesh from these and assign the equation numbers.

```

// Add the submeshes to the problem
add_sub_mesh(Bulk_mesh_pt);
add_sub_mesh(Surface_mesh_pt);

// Now build the global mesh
build_global_mesh();

// Assign equation numbers
cout << assign_eqn_numbers() << " equations assigned" << std::endl;
} // end_of_constructor

```

1.9 The traction elements

We create the face elements that apply the traction to the boundary $r = r_{\min}$.

```

//====start_of_traction=====
// Make traction elements along the boundary r=Rmin
//=====
template<class ELEMENT, class TIMESTEPPER>
void AxisymmetricLinearElasticityProblem<ELEMENT, TIMESTEPPER>::
assign_traction_elements()
{
    unsigned bound, n_neigh;

    // How many bulk elements are next to boundary 3
    bound=3;
    n_neigh = Bulk_mesh_pt->nboundary_element(bound);

    // Now loop over bulk elements and create the face elements
    for(unsigned n=0;n<n_neigh;n++)
    {
        // Create the face element
        FiniteElement *traction_element_pt
        = new AxisymmetricLinearElasticityTractionElement<ELEMENT>
        (Bulk_mesh_pt->boundary_element_pt(bound,n),
        Bulk_mesh_pt->face_index_at_boundary(bound,n));
        // Add to mesh
        Surface_mesh_pt->add_element_pt(traction_element_pt);
    }

} // end_of_assign_traction_elements

```

1.10 Initial data

The time integration in this problem is performed using the Newmark scheme which, in addition to the standard initial conditions (3), requires an initial value for the acceleration. Since we will be solving a test case in which the exact solution is known, we can use the exact solution to provide the complete set of initial data required. For the

details of the Newmark scheme, see the tutorial on the [linear wave equation](#).

If we're doing an impulsive start, set the displacement, velocity and acceleration to zero, and fill in the time history to be consistent with this.

```

//===start_of_set_initial_conditions=====
// Set the initial conditions (history values)
//=====
template<class ELEMENT, class TIMESTEPPER>
void AxisymmetricLinearElasticityProblem<ELEMENT, TIMESTEPPER>::
set_initial_conditions()
{
    // Upcast the timestepper to the specific type we have
    TIMESTEPPER* timestepper_pt =
        dynamic_cast<TIMESTEPPER*>(time_stepper_pt());

    // By default do a non-impulsive start and provide initial conditions
    bool impulsive_start=false;

    if(impulsive_start)
    {
        // Number of nodes in the bulk mesh
        unsigned n_node = Bulk_mesh_pt->nnode();

        // Loop over all nodes in the bulk mesh
        for(unsigned inod=0;inod<n_node;inod++)
        {
            // Pointer to node
            Node* nod_pt = Bulk_mesh_pt->node_pt(inod);

            // Get nodal coordinates
            Vector<double> x(2);
            x[0] = nod_pt->x(0);
            x[1] = nod_pt->x(1);

            // Assign zero solution at t=0
            nod_pt->set_value(0,0);
            nod_pt->set_value(1,0);
            nod_pt->set_value(2,0);

            // Set the impulsive initial values in the timestepper
            timestepper_pt->assign_initial_values_impulsive(nod_pt);
        }
    } // end_of_impulsive_start

```

If we are not doing an impulsive start, we must provide the timestepper with time history values for the displacement, velocity and acceleration. Each component of these vectors is represented by a function pointer, and in this case, the function pointers return values based on the exact solution.

```

else // Smooth start
{
    // Storage for pointers to the functions defining the displacement,
    // velocity and acceleration components
    Vector<typename TIMESTEPPER::NodeInitialConditionFctPt>
        initial_value_fct(3);
    Vector<typename TIMESTEPPER::NodeInitialConditionFctPt>
        initial_veloc_fct(3);
    Vector<typename TIMESTEPPER::NodeInitialConditionFctPt>
        initial_accel_fct(3);

    // Set the displacement function pointers
    initial_value_fct[0]=&Global_Parameters::u_r;
    initial_value_fct[1]=&Global_Parameters::u_z;
    initial_value_fct[2]=&Global_Parameters::u_theta;

    // Set the velocity function pointers
    initial_veloc_fct[0]=&Global_Parameters::d_u_r_dt;
    initial_veloc_fct[1]=&Global_Parameters::d_u_z_dt;
    initial_veloc_fct[2]=&Global_Parameters::d_u_theta_dt;

    // Set the acceleration function pointers
    initial_accel_fct[0]=&Global_Parameters::d2_u_r_dt2;
    initial_accel_fct[1]=&Global_Parameters::d2_u_z_dt2;
    initial_accel_fct[2]=&Global_Parameters::d2_u_theta_dt2;
}

```

Then we loop over all nodes in the bulk mesh and set the initial data values from the exact solution.

```

// Number of nodes in the bulk mesh
unsigned n_node = Bulk_mesh_pt->nnode();

// Loop over all nodes in bulk mesh
for(unsigned inod=0;inod<n_node;inod++)
{
    // Pointer to node
    Node* nod_pt = Bulk_mesh_pt->node_pt(inod);

    // Assign the history values
    timestepper_pt->assign_initial_data_values(nod_pt,
                                                initial_value_fct,
                                                initial_veloc_fct,

```

```

                                initial_accel_fct);
    } // end_of_loop_over_nodes

```

1.11 Post-processing

This member function documents the computed solution to file and calculates the error between the computed solution and the exact solution.

```

//===start_of_doc_solution=====
/// Doc the solution
//========
template<class ELEMENT, class TIMESTEPER>
void AxisymmetricLinearElasticityProblem<ELEMENT, TIMESTEPER>::
doc_solution(DocInfo& doc_info)
{
    ofstream some_file;
    char filename[100];
    // Number of plot points
    unsigned npts=10;
    // Output solution
    sprintf(filename,"%s/soln%i.dat",doc_info.directory().c_str(),
            doc_info.number());
    some_file.open(filename);
    Bulk_mesh_pt->output(some_file,npts);
    some_file.close();

    // Output exact solution
    sprintf(filename,"%s/exact_soln%i.dat",doc_info.directory().c_str(),
            doc_info.number());
    some_file.open(filename);
    Bulk_mesh_pt->output_fct(some_file,npts,time_pt()->time(),
                           Global_Parameters::exact_solution);
    some_file.close();

    // Doc error
    double error=0.0;
    double norm=0.0;
    sprintf(filename,"%s/error%i.dat",doc_info.directory().c_str(),
            doc_info.number());
    some_file.open(filename);
    Bulk_mesh_pt->compute_error(some_file,
                              Global_Parameters::exact_solution,
                              time_pt()->time(),
                              error,norm);
    some_file.close();

    // Doc error norm:
    cout << "\nNorm of error:      " << sqrt(error) << std::endl;
    cout << "Norm of solution: " << sqrt(norm) << std::endl << std::endl;
    cout << std::endl;
} // end_of_doc_solution

```

1.12 Comments

- Given that we non-dimensionalised all stresses on Young's modulus it seems odd that we provide the option to specify a non-dimensional Young's modulus via the member function `AxisymmetricLinearElasticity::youngs_modulus_pt()`. The explanation for this is that this function specifies the ratio of the material's actual Young's modulus to the Young's modulus used in the non-dimensionalisation of the equations. The capability to specify such ratios is important in problems where the elastic body is made of multiple materials with different constitutive properties. If the body is made of a single, homogeneous material, the specification of the non-dimensional Young's modulus is not required – it defaults to 1.0.

1.13 Exercises

- Try setting the boolean flag `impulsive_start` to `true` in the `AxisymmetricLinearElasticityProblem::set_` function and compare the system's evolution to that obtained when a "smooth" start from the exact solution is performed.
- Omit the specification of the Young's modulus and verify that the default value gives the same solution.
- Confirm that the assignment of the history values for the Newmark timestepper in `AxisymmetricLinearElasticityPro` sets the correct initial values for the displacement, velocity and acceleration. (Hint: the relevant code is already contained in the driver code, but was omitted in the code listings shown above.)

1.14 Source files for this tutorial

- The source files for this tutorial are located in the directory:

`demo_drivers/axisym_linear_elasticity/cylinder/`

- The driver code is:

`demo_drivers/axisym_linear_elasticity/cylinder/cylinder.cc`

1.15 PDF file

A [pdf version](#) of this document is available.